PathwayAI | U.S. Lyme burden evidence and methods

Version: 0.1.0

Evidence review: 2026-10-23

PURPOSE

Connect county surveillance with published U.S. economic and functional evidence. Document measured, assumed and missing components.

NATIONAL CONTEXT

Hook reports annual national societal-cost illustrations of $345 million to $968 million in 2016 dollars. These historical reference points are not current spending or statistical confidence limits. The original national calculation is not recomputed here.

THREE DISTINCT QUESTIONS

Annual new-case burden: costs attached to a defined group of newly occurring cases over a specified follow-up period.

Ongoing population burden: costs and functional effects among people still affected, including earlier years of onset.

Lifetime burden: cumulative effects over a longer horizon; not estimated by this framework.

COST PERSPECTIVES AND DOUBLE COUNTING

Household payments, insurer-allowed medical spending and societal totals answer different questions. Hook societal totals already include medical, nonmedical and productivity components. Do not add the Adrion differences, patient payments or another work-loss estimate to them.

Adrion reports different adjusted comparisons over 12 months, not causal savings or lifetime cost. Claims cover commercially insured ages 0–64 in 2006–2010; a single common dollar year was not established in the reviewed text.

COUNTY CALCULATION

Reported cases × $2,032 Hook societal mean = a transfer-based illustration in 2016 dollars. Applying the study experience to a county is an assumption, not a direct county measurement.

Dutchess: 1,060 reported cases × $2,032 = $2,153,920. Orange: 964 × $2,032 = $1,958,848. Reported case year: 2024.

Case source: https://www.health.ny.gov/statistics/diseases/communicable/2024/docs/cases.pdf

FUNCTION AND DISABILITY

Johnson describes selected persistent-illness respondents. Horn describes selected early-care follow-up participants. Neither supplies a directly transportable probability of county Lyme disability. All-cause HRSA/Census disability stays separate.

INTERNATIONAL COMPARISON

Country comparisons need compatible case definitions, reporting coverage, time horizons, local unit costs and currency/price years. No global total is calculated. U.S. unit costs are not applied worldwide.

International surveillance discovery: https://www.ecdc.europa.eu/en/borreliosis (portal not freshly reviewed; not a numerical input).

BURDEN INVENTORY

Component: Medical care | Available evidence: Hook societal medical component; Adrion claims-based costs; entered patient payments | Coverage / next evidence needed: Different perspectives and horizons; current Lyme-specific county spending remains unmeasured.

Component: Travel and other household spending | Available evidence: Optional personal cost records; part of Hook nonmedical costs | Coverage / next evidence needed: Comparable local records and reporting periods; no representative county average.

Component: Work disruption | Available evidence: Missed workdays; optional valuation; Johnson selected survey | Coverage / next evidence needed: Reduced hours, stopped work, reduced effectiveness and duration; prevent overlapping loss estimates.

Component: Unpaid caregiving | Available evidence: Optional hours entered in personal records | Coverage / next evidence needed: Agreed time period and valuation method; no current county dollar estimate.

Component: Daily function and quality of life | Available evidence: Patient descriptions; Johnson survey; Horn follow-up | Coverage / next evidence needed: Repeated, standardized measures; symptoms, limitations and benefits receipt are different outcomes.

Component: Longer-term disability and continuing costs | Available evidence: Selected illness studies; separate HRSA/Census all-cause context | Coverage / next evidence needed: Appropriate probability, duration, affected population and incremental cost. Not estimated from three-month symptoms or selected-survey percentages.

UNCERTAINTY AND EVIDENCE STATUS

Scenario ranges require documented assumptions. Statistical uncertainty needs an appropriate model; arbitrary ranges are not confidence intervals. Current references do not establish PathwayAI savings, resource-allocation effects or disability reduction.

Sources use different populations, periods and price years. New web downloads were blocked. Paper verification is based on supplied documents; original studies, not PathwayAI, generated the cited findings.

Hook excluded non-English speakers and nonacute disease. The evidence inventory therefore highlights important gaps for the communities PathwayAI aims to serve.

REFERENCES

Hook SA et al. (2022). Economic Burden of Reported Lyme Disease in High-Incidence Areas, United States, 2014–2016. Emerging Infectious Diseases, 28(6).

https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/eid/article/28/6/21-1335_article

Review status: Previously reviewed supplied article text; linked tables not separately retrieved.

Adrion ER, Aucott J, Lemke KW, Weiner JP. (2015). Health Care Costs, Utilization and Patterns of Care following Lyme Disease. PLOS ONE, 10(2):e0116767.

https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0116767

Review status: Uploaded full PDF reviewed.

Johnson L, Wilcox S, Mankoff J, Stricker RB. (2014). Severity of chronic Lyme disease compared to other chronic conditions: a quality of life survey. PeerJ, 2:e322.

https://doi.org/10.7717/peerj.322

Review status: Uploaded full PDF reviewed; table/narrative discrepancies recorded.

Horn EJ et al. (2025). Lyme Disease Biobank: 10 years of 3 month follow-up visits from 2014 to 2023. Frontiers in Medicine, 12:1577936.

https://doi.org/10.3389/fmed.2025.1577936

Review status: Uploaded full PDF reviewed.

Sanders GD et al. (2016). Recommendations for Conduct, Methodological Practices, and Reporting of Cost-effectiveness Analyses: Second Panel on Cost-Effectiveness in Health and Medicine. JAMA, 316(10):1093–1103.

https://doi.org/10.1001/jama.2016.12195

Review status: Bibliographic reference and supplied summary; full article not retrieved. Framework is adapted, not a claim of complete Panel compliance.

CITE THIS FRAMEWORK

Zhang, Y. (2026). PathwayAI: Lyme disease burden evidence framework (Version 0.1.0) [Software and methods]. https://github.com/gaiju/pathwayAI/tree/burden-evidence-v0.1.0

Cite the original study for its findings. This citation identifies software/methods, not a peer-reviewed study, government estimate, endorsement or DOI-registered archive.